Petaluma Police Dept. - CA

ALPR Policy and Usage

Last Updated: Nov 11, 2026 04:05 AM -08:00

Overview

Petaluma Police Dept. - CA uses Axon Automatic License Plate Reader (ALPR) technology to capture objective evidence without compromising individual privacy. We utilize real-time alerting in patrol vehicles to arrest wanted criminals, recover stolen vehicles and locate missing persons that are on various hotlists. We also retain vehicle and plate images for a period of time to perform searches when investigating reported crimes. All of this data is secure, not sold to 3rd parties, and only used for law enforcement purposes by authorized personnel. This page shows our ALPR policies and usage statistics so that you may understand how this technology is used to help keep your community safer.

ALPR Terms

Hotlist
A list of known license plates and vehicles of interest, which are stolen, wanted for or potentially associated with unlawful activity or missing persons.

Read Record
A record of a plate that was read that was not associated with any hotlist at the time it was captured.

Hit Record
A record of a plate that was read that matched a plate number on a hotlist and generated an alert.

What is detected

License plate image, vehicle image, plate text, date, time and location.

What is not detected

Facial images, people, gender, or race.

Acceptable Use Policy

Data is used for law enforcement purposes only. Data is agency-owned and is never sold to 3rd parties.

Prohibited Uses

Harassment, intimidation, usage based solely on a protected class (race, sex, religion, etc....), personal use.

Data Policy Access

All data searches require a valid search reason or case number which is captured in audit logs and stored indefinitely.

Hotlist Policy

Hotlist alerts are required to be human-verified before taking action.

Policy Settings

Plate Read Record Retention

30 Days

Hotlist Hit Record Retention

30 Days

Hotlist Categories & Hits

- Attempt to Locate
- Prostitution
- Amber Alert
- Protective Interest
- Unrenewable
- Person of Interest
- Sex Offense
- Terrorist Suspect
- Aggravated Assault
- Death Suspicious
- Felony Theft
- Stop and Hold
- Child Abductor
- Misdemeanor
- Protection Order
- Gang or Suspected Terrorist
- Suspended Plate
- Assault
- Threats to Law Enforcement
- No Insurance
- Gang Member
- Deported Felon
- Disqualified Plate
- Pointer Vehicle

Violent Person

Expired

Suspended with Registrant

Stolen License Plate

CPIC Data Records

Supervised Release

HAZMAT

Sex Offender

Spoiled

Felony Warrant

Revoked License

Theft

Hit and Run

Robbery

Battery Assault

Suspended in Possession

Cancelled/Terminated

Disorderly Conduct

DFS Alert

Stolen Vehicle

Bank Robbery

Narcotics

Felony Vehicle

Stop & ID

Missing Person

Harassment

Prohibited

Gang or Suspected Terrorist

Missing License / License Plate

Wanted Vehicle

Stolen / Unissued License

Notice of Seizure

Capias Warrant

Special Interest Person (SIP)

Abandoned Vehicle

Revoked Plate

Homicide

Sex Offender

Stolen Plate

Fugitive

BOLO

Sanctioned Driver

Suspended Driver

Wanted Person

Parole

Warrants

Bias Incident

Violent Person

Expired License

Threat to Kill

Unattached

Other

Kidnapping

Missing Person

Stolen Vehicle

Silver Alert

Used in Misdemeanor or Felony Offense

Court Action

Law Enforcement Suspect

Suspended Registration

Stalking

Unlicensed Driver

Car Jacking

Arson

Supervised Release

Expired Tag

Plate in Poor Standing

Terrorist

Terminated

Law Enforcement Purpose

Armed Robbery

Suspect

Reported Lost/Missing

Warrants

Weapons Poss/Dist

Burglary

Usage Metrics

Plate Reads Retained

18,102 Retained

Hotlist Hits Retained

5 Retained

Active ALPR Devices

in the last 30 days

1	1	0	0
Total	Fleet	Outpost	Lightpost